



Lecture 03

Visual Aids

Visual Aids

- With the advent of graphics programs for personal computers, writers have available a number of choices for using visual aids.
- Computers easily convert data to many kinds of visuals.
- The bar graphs, line graphs, and pie charts.
- This Lecture explains a number of different types of visual aids, shows how to discuss them in the document, and tells when to use them

Types of visual aids

- There are three basic types of visual aids are
 - tables , graphs, charts.
 - Graphics
 - Illustrations*
- * An illustration is a decoration, interpretation or visual explanation of a text, concept or process, designed for integration in published media, such as posters, flyers, magazines, books, teaching materials, animations, video games and films.

TABLES

- Tables are especially for communicating **numeric information**.
- If a table is borrowed from another source, that source must be cited along with the description/heading of the table.

Tables

	Men	Women	Children's	
India	50	40	10	
China	45	55	10	
Iran	35	65	20	
Pakistan	45	45	20	

Table description placed above table.

Tables are numbered according to the order in which they are shown or referred to in the text. A full stop follows the word Table and the table number.

If the table description forms a complete sentence, a full stop is placed at the end; otherwise, not.

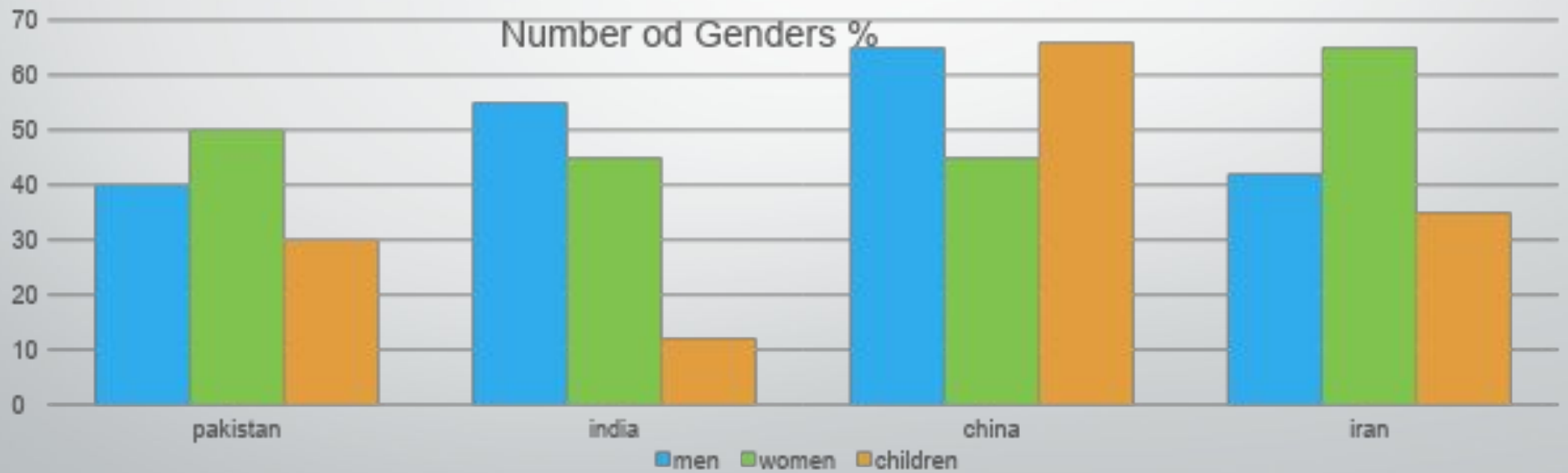
Table 2. Jyväskylä residents' library patronage by age group

Columns and rows labeled precisely, using complete words.

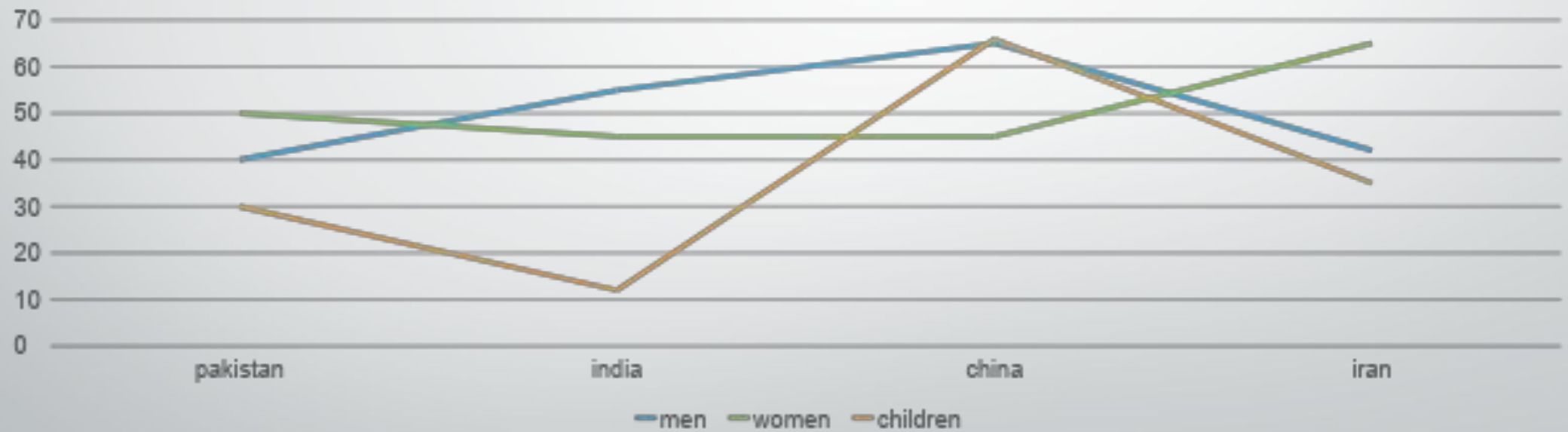
	Under 25 years	25–60 years	Over 60 years	All
	n = 435	n = 1425	n = 1140	N = 3000
	%	%	%	%
Once per week	18	5	11	11
Once per month	50	57	25	44
Less often	32	38	64	45
Total	100	100	100	100

Two empty rows before and after the table.

Bar Chart



Line Chart



Pie Chart

men



■ pakistan ■ india ■ china ■ iran

Illustrations



Team Creative
Stock Image

Copyright © ChihHang Chung 2008

References to diagrams, graphs, tables and equations

- Figure 1.2 Graph of energy output as a function of wave height.
- see figure 1.2
- Table 3.1 Performance specifications of a range of commercially available GaAsFET devices
- In this example, the first table in section 3 might be referred to by "...with reference to the performance specifications provided in Table 3.1..."
- Number equations as follows;
$$F(\text{dB}) = 10 \cdot \log_{10}(F) \quad (3.6)$$
- In this example, the sixth equation in section 3 might be referred to by "...noise figure in decibels as given by eqn (3.6)..."

Guidelines for Effective Visual Aids

- 1. Construct high-quality visual aids, **using clear lines**, words, numbers, and organization.
- Research shows that the quality of the visual aid is the most important factor in its effectiveness.

Guidelines for Effective Visual Aids

- 2. Make sure a visual **conveys only one point**. If you include too much data, readers cannot grasp the meaning readily.
- Do not clutter a visual aid with too many words or lines, causing it to lose its visual quality and impact.

Guidelines for Effective Visual Aids

- 3. Refer to each visual aid in the text, (usually by number, e.g. “see **Figure 1**”), even if the illustration is right beside or below your discussion of it, and explain or interpret each one.

FORMATTING

- To format is to make choices that affect a page's appearance.
- The phenomenal growth of word processing and the ready availability of desktop publishing programs and laser printers mean that writers must understand formatting.
- **This section explains three basic formatting areas:**
 - How to design a page
 - How to emphasize material

How to Design a Page

- To design a page means to arrange it so that it effectively presents the contents to the reader.
- Software programs such as '**Microsoft Word, Word Perfect, Page and Ready, Set, Go! now**' give writers the ability to manipulate the elements of design.

How to Emphasize_(importance)

- **To achieve emphasis, you highlight. Highlighting means to make an item look different from the items, around it.**
- You can highlight by using boldface, all capitals, underlining, or vertical lists.
- Highlight – but not too much .
- Use boldface as the most effective highlight (underlining is the most effective for typed material).
- Avoid long phrases written in all capital letters .
- Use vertical lists to emphasize the items in a series.



End